CRAIG TANAKA CHIPENDO
404-409-3490 | craigtanakac@gmail.com | Portfolio | LinkedIn

EDUCATION

EMORY UNIVERSITY, GOIZUETA BUSINESS SCHOOL Atlanta, GA
Master of Science in Business Analytics (MSBA), STEM credentialed program *May 2026*

- Relevant Coursework: Managing Big Data, AI and Machine Learning, Data Visualization, Causal Inference, Deep and Reinforcement Learning, Quantitative Strategies and Financial Analytics, and Prescriptive Analytics.
- Merit Scholarship Recipient
- Graduate Research Assistant – Data Science

UNIVERSITY OF ZIMBABWE Harare, Zimbabwe
Bachelor of Science in Data Science and Systems (Honors Degree) *Jun 2024*

- GPA: 4.0 | University of Zimbabwe Book Prize — Best student in class of 2024
- Thesis: Uncovering and mitigating algorithmic bias in Convolutional Neural Networks (CNN) based facial detection systems using Variational Autoencoders (VAEs)

TECHNICAL CAPABILITIES

Data Science Tools: GCP (BigQuery, Vertex AI), AWS, Power BI, Tableau, Hadoop, NoSQL, Spark, Kafka
Programming Languages: Python (Google ADK, Langchain, Tensorflow, Pandas, PyTorch), R, SQL

WORK EXPERIENCE

THE HOME DEPOT Atlanta, Georgia
Data Science Consultant – Practicum *Dec 2025 – May 2026*

- Architected a multi-agent policy-aware route intelligence system that reduced modeled first-attempt delivery failures 10-13%, mitigating an estimated cost of $10-12 per avoided failed delivery
- Encoded SOPs and policy documents into a Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) powered policy agent, targeting a lift 5-10% in customer satisfaction scores tied to on-time, damage free deliveries
- Built end-to-end agentic workflows from raw work orders to order-level recommendations, establishing evaluation protocols measuring task adherence, tool call accuracy, and intent resolution using LLM-as-a-judge frameworks to ensure 90%+ groundedness and policy alignment at scale

LIQUID INTELLIGENT TECHNOLOGIES Harare, Zimbabwe
Data Analytics and AI Specialist *Mar 2025 – Jul 2025*

- Developed and deployed deep neural network models for anomaly detection and network fault forecasting on operational time-series data, reducing platform downtime by 20% and increasing user engagement by 18%
- Designed predictive analytics pipelines applying feature engineering and autoregressive techniques to complex real-time network datasets, improving fault prediction accuracy
- Collaborated with domain experts and business stakeholders to translate technical findings into structured analytical tasks, bridging rigorous statistical analysis with tangible business impact
- Built six Power BI executive dashboards monitoring experiment KPIs, service adoption, and performance metrics to enable data-driven roadmap and investment decisions

Data Analytics Graduate Trainee *Sep 2024 – Feb 2025*

- Engineered advanced ETL pipelines on complex real-time datasets in BigQuery, improving enterprise data quality by 12% and supporting regulated, audit-ready analytics.
- Developed automated Python-based reporting and anomaly-flagging workflows for network traffic, cutting incident detection and response time by 30% and enhancing operational efficiency
- Improved troubleshooting by designing a custom web-based network topology application that visualizes traffic flows, reducing making it easier to identify faulty links

EXPERT DECISION SYSTEMS (XDS) ZIMBABWE Harare, Zimbabwe
Data Science Intern *Aug 2022 - Jul 2023*

- Built and deployed a machine learning loan-default prediction model integrated into official credit reports, enabling lenders and insurers to better quantify risk and make more accurate, data-driven credit decisions
- Queried and analyzed 70M+ records using SQL and PySpark to generate underwriting and portfolio-risk insights, influencing lending policies and improving model monitoring across multiple financial partners
- Built revenue data and sales forecast reporting, improving decision-making by 5% improving decision-making

PROJECT EXPERIENCE

UNIVERSITY OF ZIMBABWE Harare, Zimbabwe
X (Formerly known as Twitter) Sentiment Analysis for E-Commerce insights *Summer 2023*

- Developed an NLP pipeline to analyze and classify customer sentiment from X (Twitter) posts related to e-commerce brands and products using Python (TensorFlow, Scikit-learn) and Spark
- Engineered deep neural networks (LSTM) and classical machine learning models for text classification, information extraction, and polarity prediction, informing customer support and product development

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

- STEM credential offers up to three years U.S. Work Authorization eligibility